

Malaysia Car Rental Industry

Market structure, player deep-dives & strategic outlook

Prepared for: HJ Date: 20 June 2026 Focus: Tier 1 & Tier 2 player intelligence

1. Executive Summary

Malaysia's car rental market is a ~USD 0.62–0.67 billion industry (2025–2026) growing at ~8.4% CAGR toward ~USD 1.0–1.15 billion by 2031–2032, driven by record tourism (38M arrivals in 2024), app-based self-drive mobility, and EV incentives.

~USD 0.67B

MARKET SIZE 2026

~8.4%

CAGR TO 2031

~USD 1B+

FORECAST 2031

1,000+

REGISTERED OPERATORS

Headline insight: the market is effectively a **duopoly of conglomerates** sitting above a long tail. **GoCar is 99.64%-owned by Mayflower** (Warisan TC Holdings / Tan Chong group), while **SOCAR + TREVO** are owned by South Korea's **SK Group**. Your "Tier 1 app player" and "Tier 2 incumbent" GoCar/Mayflower are *one* group running a two-brand strategy.

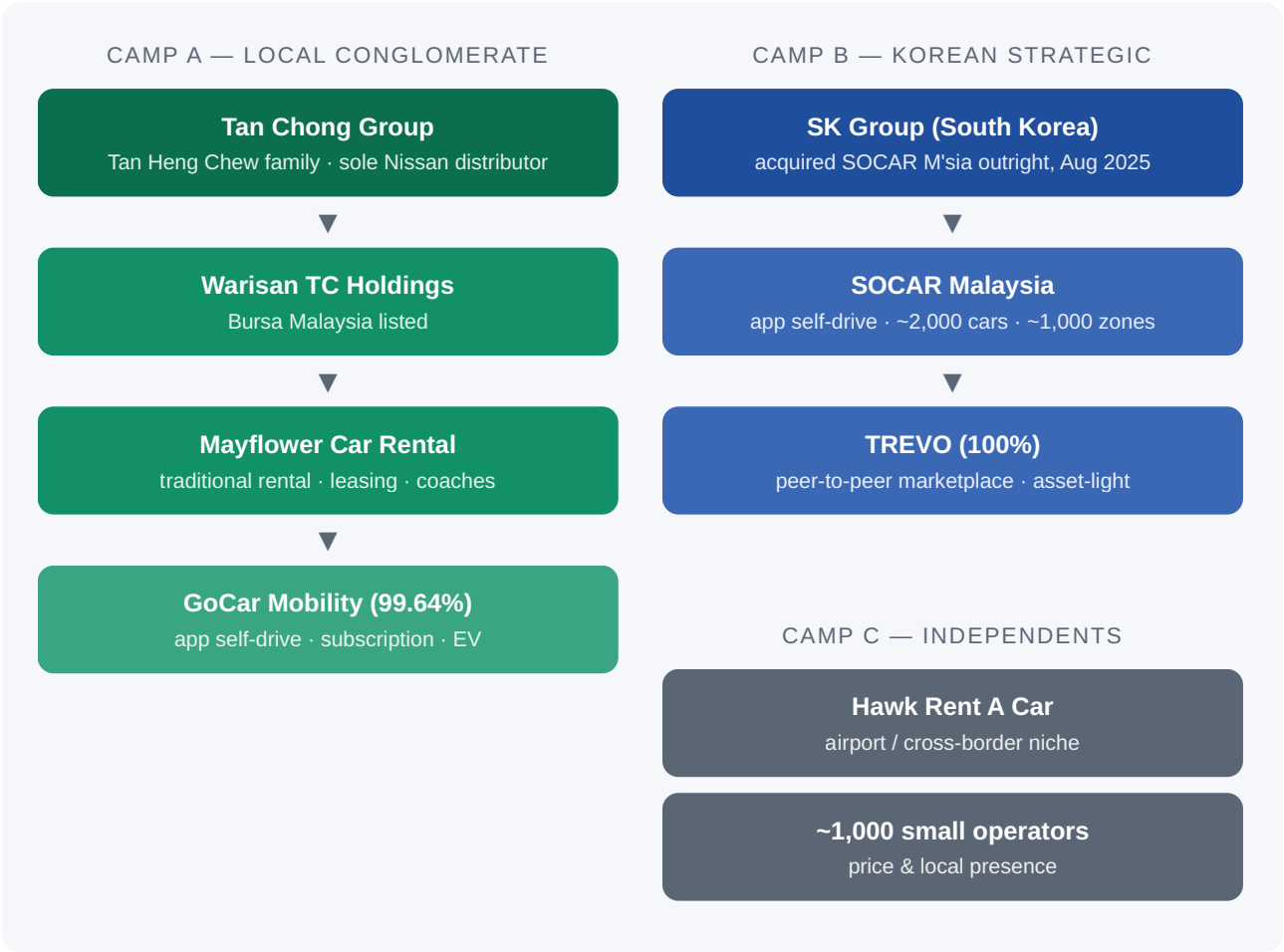
2. Market Size & Growth

Metric	Value	Source basis
Market size 2025	~USD 0.62B (one report: USD 595.97M)	Mordor / Verified Market Research
Market size 2026	~USD 0.67B	Mordor Intelligence
Forecast 2031 / 2032	~USD 1.01B / ~USD 1.15B	Mordor / Verified Market Research
CAGR	~8.4–8.5%	Multiple

Segments (2025): Individuals ≈ 72.4% of demand · Tourism & leisure ≈ 67.6% of use.

3. Market Structure — A Duopoly of Groups

Over **1,000 registered operators** compete, but value concentrates in **two conglomerate camps** plus the independent Hawk and a long tail of small players.



4. Player Deep-Dives

TIER 1 & TIER 2

SOCAR Malaysia

Tier 1 · App self-drive

~2,000

CARS IN FLEET

~1,000

ZONES

~US\$73M

FUNDING RAISED

~US\$213M

PEAK VALUATION

RM66M

REVENUE (2022)

Ownership: Acquired outright by **SK Group (Korea), Aug 2025** (prev. 60% SK Holdings / 40% SOCAR Korea). Funding: US\$18M Series A (2019) + US\$55M Series B (2021).

Business model: Pure app-based, zone-based car-sharing (hourly → monthly). Capital-heavy *owned* fleet monetized via high utilization + AI dynamic pricing (rates flex by location/time).

Strategy / plan:

- **Density over breadth** — saturate KL, Penang, JB rather than go nationwide.
- **Revenue-per-user add-ons:** SOCAR-2-YOU (delivery), SOCAR+ (driver), sub-brands BOSS & DASH.
- **Asset-light layer via TREVO** — grow supply without buying cars.
- **Post-SK acquisition** — recapitalization + tighter integration with SK's regional mobility ambitions.

Know this: the capital-intensive, strategically-funded model — deep pockets, scale-driven economics, but answers to a foreign parent's regional priorities.

GoCar Malaysia

Tier 1 · App self-drive (Warisan/Tan Chong)

~1,000

VEHICLES · 7 STATES

2014

FOUNDED

99.64%

OWNED BY
MAYFLOWER

RM13.90/hr

ENTRY PRICE

2022

F&S CAR-SHARING CO. OF YEAR

Ownership: 99.64% Mayflower → Warisan TC Holdings (listed) → Tan Chong group (also Nissan's Malaysian distributor). Started with 5 cars in Klang Valley.

Business model: App self-drive like SOCAR — but built as a "rent → subscribe → own" ladder, its core differentiator:

- **GoCar Sharing** — hourly/daily (from RM13.90/hr)
- **GoCar Subscription** — flexible monthly, no ownership commitment
- **GoCar Pro** (Johor Bahru) — sharing/subscription hybrid, faster turnaround
- **GoEV** — Tesla Model Y, Hyundai Ioniq 5/Kona, Renault Zoe, Ora Good Cat, Nissan Leaf

Strategy / plan: "Future of car rental AND ownership" — funnels subscribers toward purchase (synergy with parent's car-distribution arm). Partnerships: Renault (150 Capturs), Shell (100 stations), chargeEV & JomCharge. Backed by a **listed parent's balance sheet** → patient capital, less burn than SOCAR.

Know this: vertical integration is the edge — parent sells cars, runs the traditional rental arm (Mayflower), and owns dealer/financing rails. The subscription-to-ownership funnel is hard for SOCAR to copy.

TREVO

Tier 1 · Peer-to-peer (SOCAR subsidiary)

P2P

MARKETPLACE
MODEL

~21

CAR BRANDS LISTED

0

CARS OWNED (ASSET-
LIGHT)

100%

OWNED BY SOCAR

Business model: The "Turo/Airbnb of cars" — owners ("hosts") list, renters ("guests") book; TREVO takes commission and provides the trust layer (payments, verification, **TREVO Shield** — Malaysia's first P2P rental insurance). Inventory spans Audi, Bentley, Mazda etc.

Know this: the **most capital-efficient model** in the market — supply scales with car owners, not capex. Easiest to copy, hardest to win (needs two-sided liquidity + insurance partnerships).

Mayflower Car Rental

Tier 2 · Incumbent (Warisan/Tan Chong)

1963

MALAYSIA'S FIRST

Listed

WARISAN TC
HOLDINGS

6+

NATIONWIDE
LOCATIONS

99.64%

OWNS GOCAR

Ownership: Warisan TC Holdings Berhad (Bursa-listed) → Tan Chong group. **Owns 99.64% of GoCar.**

Fleet: one of Malaysia's largest ground-transport fleets — sedans, MPVs, tour vans, **air-conditioned coaches**. Network: KL HQ + KLIA, Penang, Johor, Kuantan, Sabah, Sarawak.

Business model (B2B-weighted): car rental & **long-term leasing**; **fleet management** (maintenance, insurance, 24/7 breakdown); **coach rental & chauffeur** (tourism, MICE, corporate).

Strategy / plan: own corporate/institutional contracts (sticky, less price-sensitive); leverage coach + tour-agency heritage for tourism/MICE; run the digital/retail future *through GoCar* (bought 2016 to avoid being disrupted).

Know this: the "old money" incumbent — scale, trust, government/corporate relationships, listed backing, and a coach/chauffeur business app players don't touch. Weakness: legacy cost base, slower native digital (outsourced to GoCar).

Hawk Rent A Car (M) Sdn Bhd

Tier 2 · Independent

1994/95

FOUNDED

~10

OFFICES / KIOSKS

~US\$5.1M

REVENUE

~28

EMPLOYEES (LEAN)

Network: KLIA, KLIA2, KL city centre + key West & East Malaysia cities; **Hong Kong & Singapore offices** + global partner network. HQ Subang Jaya, Selangor.

Business model: traditional counter/branch-based passenger car rental — airport pickups, city branches, corporate accounts; "young fleet" positioning (well-maintained, regularly refreshed).

Strategy / plan: airport + cross-border focus (inbound & regional business travelers); asset-right, lean ops with partner network instead of owning branches everywhere; competes on service consistency and reach, not tech or price.

Know this: the independent specialist — no listed parent, no app ambitions. Squeezed between app players (convenience) and the long tail (price), but airport positioning + regional offices are genuine assets.

5. Competitor Comparison Matrix

Dimension	SOCAR	GoCar	TREVO	Mayflower	Hawk
Type	App self-drive	App self-drive	P2P market	Traditional + lease	Traditional
Fleet	~2,000	~1,000 (7 states)	Asset-light (0 owned)	Large, mixed + coaches	Young fleet, ~10 sites
Owner	SK Group (Korea)	Mayflower / Warisan	SOCAR	Warisan TC (listed)	Independent
Capital model	VC + strategic	Listed parent	Marketplace	Listed corporate	SME
Core customer	Urban individuals	Individuals → owners	Owners + renters	Corporate, MICE, govt	Airport, cross-border
Pricing	AI dynamic	Tiered + subscription	Host-set + commission	Negotiated / lease	Fixed / corporate
EV play	Moderate	Strong (GoEV)	Host-dependent	Emerging	Limited
Moat	Scale, density, pricing	Rent → own funnel, integration	Capital efficiency	Contracts, coaches, trust	Airport + regional niche
Vulnerability	Burn, foreign parent	Modest entity revenue	Needs liquidity	Legacy cost, slow digital	Squeezed both ends

6. Pricing & Rental Terms HOW THEY CHARGE

One market, **four distinct pricing models**. How a player charges reveals its strategy more clearly than anything else.

Model	Who	Unit of charge	Entry price
Pay-per-use sharing	SOCAR, GoCar	Per minute / hour / day	RM6–9/hr · ~RM30–69/day
Subscription	GoCar Subs	Per month (1–36 mo)	from RM899/month
Traditional rental	Mayflower, Hawk, Avis, Hertz	Per day / week / month	~RM130–410/day
Peer-to-peer	TREVO	Host-set daily + commission	from RM50/day

The price ladder

RM3–9 / hour

SOCAR / GoCar hourly — spontaneous urban hops

RM30–69 / day

Pay-per-use daily — day trips, errands

RM50+ / day (host-set)

TREVO P2P — variety incl. luxury (Audi, Bentley)

RM130–410 / day

Mayflower / Hawk traditional — full-service, unlimited mileage

RM899+ / month

GoCar Subs — "ownership without buying", recurring revenue

Per-player pricing & charging mechanics

Player	Headline rate	How it charges (fuel / mileage / deposit)
SOCAR	From RM6–8/hr (promo RM3/hr · RM30/day); weekday < weekend; AI dynamic	Fuel included up to 30km/hr or 300km/day, then RM0.25/km · No deposit · return ≥50% tank or RM100 penalty · add-on Damage Waiver
GoCar Sharing	From RM0.17/min or RM69/day (unlimited mileage)	All-inclusive: insurance, road tax, servicing, wear & tear, 24/7 roadside · fuel card · low/no deposit
GoCar Subs	From RM899/month · 8 vehicle tiers	Monthly: deposit + one-time fee · 12–36 mo: deposit + first month · SWAP car 2×/yr (12mo+) · all running costs bundled
TREVO	Host-set, from ~RM50/day	Platform takes min 25% commission + 8% SST (effective ~25–35%) · free to list cars <10 yrs · host paid 2 weeks post-trip
Mayflower	~RM130/day (Axia) to ~RM230–410/day	Daily/weekly/monthly + long-term lease · maintenance, insurance, 24/7 breakdown bundled · refundable deposit · unlimited mileage
Hawk	~RM158–343/day (avg ~RM225)	Refundable deposit · age 23+, licence ≥2 yrs · RM3M third-party cover · free delivery within 5km

"Rent a Perodua Myvi for one week" — illustrative comparison

7 days, ~300–400 km usage, economy car. Indicative — actual app rates flex with promos & dynamic pricing.

Player	Model	~1-week cost	Deposit	Mileage	Fuel	Best for
SOCAR	Per hour/day sharing	~RM350–480	None	Capped 300km/day	Included	Short hops, no credit card
GoCar Sharing	Per-day, unlimited	~RM480 (RM69×7)	None / low	Unlimited	Fuel card	Day trips, longer drives
GoCar Subs	Weekly/monthly sub	from ~RM1,200 (EV wk) / RM899/mo	Yes + one-time	Generous	Owner-style	1+ month users
TREVO	P2P daily (host-set)	~RM350–630	Host-set	Host-set	Renter refuels	Variety / luxury
Mayflower	Traditional weekly	~RM700–900	RM400+	Unlimited	Renter refuels	Corporate, full-service
Hawk	Traditional weekly	~RM700–1,000	RM400+	Unlimited	Renter refuels	Airport, cross-border

Standard terms across the traditional segment

Term	Typical requirement
Minimum age	23 (some 21; luxury 25). Hertz: 21–75 normal, 25–65 luxury
Licence	Valid, held 1–2 years; IDP preferred for foreigners
Deposit	RM400–RM4,000, held on a credit card in the renter's own name
Insurance	CDW included, but renter liable for excess of ~RM19,000–29,000 unless top-up bought
Mileage	Usually unlimited (vs. capped in pay-per-use sharing)
Billing	Daily/weekly at end; monthly / 6- / 11-month billed on the 1st of the month

What the pricing reveals about the industry

- **The deposit is a strategic weapon.** SOCAR's zero deposit vs. traditional's RM400–4,000 credit-card hold is the biggest reason app players won the young/urban segment.
- **"All-inclusive" is the new battleground.** Fuel + insurance + road tax + servicing bundled into one RM/day number favors scale players and squeezes small operators.
- **Mileage is where margins hide.** Sharing caps mileage (300km/day) and charges RM0.25/km overage; traditional sells unlimited mileage to road-trippers.
- **Stickiness splits three ways:** transactional (SOCAR/TREVO) vs. recurring (GoCar Subs, Mayflower leasing). Subscription converts a price-war commodity into a contract — the strategic prize.

- **TREVO's 25–35% take-rate** is high for a marketplace (Airbnb ~14–16%) — works only because owners lack alternatives to monetize idle cars; a lower-commission rival could disrupt it.
- **Wide price ladder = room for specialists.** Each rung is a different customer/margin profile; a focused entrant can own a rung (premium/EV, MICE coaches, expat long-term leasing) the giants treat as an afterthought.

7. Industry Trends & Drivers

- **Tourism boom:** 38M inbound arrivals (2024) → sustained self-drive demand; tourism ≈ 67.6% of market.
- **EV incentives (2023):** tax breaks for adding EVs; airport/highway infra upgrades; digital road-tax compliance.
- **Digital-first standard:** contactless rental, real-time tracking, app booking now table stakes.
- **Subscription rise:** flexible monthly mobility competing with ownership (GoCar leading).
- **Margin pressure:** 1,000+ operators → price competition; differentiation shifting to tech, EV, service depth.

8. Opportunity Read

STRATEGIC LENS

Where the money & momentum are

- **Subscription / flexible long-term mobility** — recurring revenue, defensible vs. price wars.
- **EV fleet + charging ecosystem** — policy tailwinds, differentiation; capex-heavy but moat-building.
- **Asset-light P2P / aggregation** — scale supply without owning vehicles (TREVO proved it locally).
- **Underserved geographies** — tourist islands & East Malaysia still dominated by fragmented, low-tech operators.

Risks / watch-outs

- Saturation (1,000+ operators) → **price-war margin erosion** in commodity short-term rental.
- **Capital intensity** of owned fleets; residual-value & utilization risk.
- Two well-capitalized groups (Warisan/Tan Chong & SK) hold **data, pricing, integration** advantages — hard to beat head-on in urban self-drive.
- Insurance, fraud, vehicle-damage exposure (especially P2P).

Most attractive angles for a new entrant

- **Niche / premium or specialist fleet** (luxury, EV, MPV/coach for MICE & tourism) over commodity sedans.

- **B2B corporate leasing + fleet management** — stickier, less price-sensitive than tourist self-drive.
- **Tech-enabled regional play** in an underserved state, partnering on charging/insurance from day one.

9. Sources

- [Mordor Intelligence — Malaysia Car Rental Market](#) · [Top Companies](#)
- [Verified Market Research](#) · [Ken Research](#)
- [SoyaCincau — SOCAR 2,000 cars / 1,000 zones](#) · [Tracxn — SOCAR funding/valuation](#)
- [DealStreetAsia — Mayflower buys 55% of GoCar](#) · [Business Standard](#)
- [Warisan TC Holdings — Travel & Car Rental](#) · [GoCar — Our Story](#)
- [paultan.org — TREVO P2P](#) · [Hawk Rent A Car](#) · [EMIS — Hawk profile](#)
- **Pricing/terms:** [SOCAR rates](#) · [GoCar rates](#) · [GoCar Subs](#) · [TREVO commission](#) · [Hawk FAQ](#) · [Avis terms](#) · [SOCAR review \(fuel/mileage\)](#)

Fleet and financial figures are the most recently reported public numbers and shift over time; entity-level revenue figures from data aggregators likely understate true group activity. Directional, not audited. Prepared as a market-intelligence brief for internal strategic use.